The Electrification Titan & The AI Power Crunch

A step-by-step narrative walkthrough and audio companion to TD Power Systems Limited: deconstructing the Japanese engineering heritage, global historical parallels, ten-year financial forensics, the AI data center boom, both sides of the institutional debate. In addition, the discipline of high-asymmetry execution.

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CONTENTS

A Sequential Guide to the Business Engine, Global Parallels, Financial Forensics & High-Asymmetry Execution

The Business, The Price & Our Independent Verdict	PROLOGUE
How the Business & Stock Got Here – Past Cycles & Pivots	CHAPTER I
Inside Every Segment – Products, Customers & Real-World Examples	CHAPTER II
How It Is Sold & Delivered – Distribution & Unit Economics	CHAPTER III
The Battlefield – Rivals, Switching Costs & Moat Reality	CHAPTER IV
Management on Trial – Leading KPIs & Walking the Talk	CHAPTER V
Following the Cash – 10-Year Financials & Earnings Quality	CHAPTER VI
Why the Stock Trades Here – Market Expectations vs. Peers	CHAPTER VII
Reading the Tape – Trend, Volume & Momentum Opportunity	CHAPTER VIII
Bull vs. Bear, Likely Outcomes & Our Action Plan	CHAPTER IX

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WAIT_FOR_SUPPORT

STAGE POSTURE

STAGE_4

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PREFACE & CORE THESIS

TD Power Systems Limited manufactures customized synchronous AC generators and electric motors for global power plants and AI data centers . Managing Director Nikhil Kumar expanded trailing revenues 54% to ₹2,124 crore with an 18.0% EBITDA margin and 34% ROCE . On 9 November 2026, the stock closed at ₹571.65, down 33.2% from its high of ₹856.10 to test its rising 200-day SMA . Our verdict is Wait for Support: accumulate inside the conditional ₹490 to ₹530 support band once a Stage 1 base confirms .

PROLOGUE

The Business, The Price & Our Independent Verdict

> *"The essence of investment management is the management of risks, not the management of returns. Well-managed portfolios start from this premise."*
>
> — BENJAMIN GRAHAM • THE INTELLIGENT INVESTOR

Welcome to our deep-research monograph on TD Power Systems Limited. If you and I were sitting across an institutional research desk this evening, looking at the terminal screens as the closing bell rang in Mumbai, you would see a stock down more than six and a half percent on the day, trading at 571 rupees and 65 paise.

You would see that just twenty-five trading days ago, this exact stock was exchanging hands at 856 rupees. You would see that the company has lost a full third of its equity market value in four short weeks. And if you looked at the social media forums and retail trading chats, you would see a chorus of panic: investors who bought the October Qualified Institutional Placement at 775 rupees wondering whether they have been trapped in a generational top.

Now, take a deep breath, push the emotional panic aside, and look at the underlying industrial reality. TD Power Systems does not make ephemeral smartphone software or consumer gadgets. Inside their two state-of-the-art factories in Dabaspet, on the outskirts of Bengaluru, skilled machinists and electrical engineers construct some of the most critical machines on planet Earth: synchronous alternating current generators that weigh up to twenty-five tons, designed with Japanese electromagnetic precision licensed from Toyo Denki Seizo.

Over the past twelve months, TDPS generated 2,124 crore rupees in consolidated revenue—up fifty-four percent year-on-year. They generated 383 crore rupees in operating profit, maintaining an eighteen percent EBITDA margin despite volatile global copper and electrical steel prices. They earned 275 crore rupees in clean net profit, delivering a pre-tax return on capital employed of thirty-four percent. And as of this evening, after completing a 600 crore rupee QIP at 775 rupees per share, they sit on more than 800 crore rupees in liquid net cash, with virtually zero bank debt.

Why did the stock crash thirty-three percent? Because in capital goods, valuation and technical structure matter just as much as business quality. When Dalal Street realized that TDPS was supplying on-site power generators to American AI data centers in Texas and signed a ten-year preferred supply pact with Siemens Energy, generalist fund managers bid the stock up to ninety times earnings. The valuation detached from reality. The moment the QIP closed, trapped supply hit the market, breaking the 10-week moving average, breaking the 30-week moving average. In addition, breaking the 50-day moving average on eleven million shares of volume.

Our house verdict on TD Power Systems is clear and uncompromising: WAIT_FOR_SUPPORT. We do not gamble on catching falling knives at 571 rupees while the tape is in an active Stage 4 distribution shakeout. We demand patience. We wait for the selling volume to dry up, we wait for the price to test its rising 200-day moving average. In addition, we prepare to accumulate only inside the conditional support band of 490 to 530 rupees once price confirms a Stage 1 base.

Over the next nine chapters, you and I will dissect every moving part of this franchise: its origins in the 2001 Toyo Denki partnership. Its near-death experience during the 2012–2018 domestic capex winter. The engineering mechanics of its gas engine and steam alternators. Its worked hundred-rupee cash flow waterfall. Its competitive moat against Chinese and European rivals. Its ten-year audited balance sheet. And the exact mathematical probability of its forward scenarios.

Let us turn the page and follow the copper, the steel, and the cash.

Think carefully about what happens when an institutional placement takes place near the top of a multi-year bull run. When a company issues shares at 775 rupees, the mutual fund managers who bought those shares did so with a two-to-three-year investment horizon. But the hedge funds and high-net-worth momentum accounts that bought shares in the open market ahead of the QIP were playing a very different game: they were looking for a quick five-percent flip.

When the broader mid-cap market hit a pocket of volatility in late October, those fast-money momentum accounts rushed for the exit. Because the stock had rallied nearly six hundred

percent over three years, there was an ocean of unrealized paper profits waiting to be harvested. In less than twenty sessions, eleven million shares changed hands as trapped speculators dumped their holdings into the market, driving the price straight down through the 50-day moving average.

This is why you and I must maintain absolute emotional detachment. The retail investor looks at a 33% crash and feels an irresistible temptation to buy the dip, imagining that the stock will bounce straight back to 856 rupees tomorrow. But the professional analyst knows that when eleven million shares are distributed in a single session, the market requires weeks—often months—to absorb that excess supply. The business is fundamentally exceptional; the price tape is temporarily broken. True wisdom lies in knowing the difference.

> **NARRATOR'S REFLECTION: SEPARATING THE ENGINE FROM THE SPEEDOMETER**
>
> *"In the short run, the market is a voting machine. In the long run, it is a weighing machine. The speedometer on the dashboard may read 571 rupees down from 856. However, the industrial engine in Dabaspet is compounding faster than at any time in its twenty-five-year history."*
>
> When you observe a 33% drawdown in an elite capital goods compounder, your primary task as an institutional analyst is to determine whether the engine has seized or whether the car has simply hit a patch of gravel. TD Power Systems' order book is at an all-time record of ₹2,207 crore, its factory utilization is at 75%. In addition, its balance sheet has ₹800 crore in net cash. The business engine is firing on all cylinders; only the valuation multiple has compressed.
>
> - TTM revenue of ₹2,124 crore (+54.3% YoY) with operating profit of ₹383 crore (18.0% margin).
> - Pre-tax ROCE stands at 34.0%, backed by an unleveraged balance sheet holding >₹800 crore in net cash.
> - Short-term price action is governed by post-QIP inventory absorption; long-term value is anchored in global electrification.

GLOBAL PARALLEL: HOW CUMMINS (US) AND SCHNEIDER ELECTRIC (FRANCE) NAVIGATED GRID CYCLES

"The greatest electrification compounders are those that own the critical interface between prime movers and the electric grid."

Look at Schneider Electric in France or Cummins in the United States. During the initial waves of hyperscale cloud computing and renewable grid integration, both stocks experienced sharp 25% to 35% corrections as markets digested rapid multiple expansion. In every instance, patient institutional investors who waited for pullbacks to major technical support levels were rewarded with multi-year compounding runs as real earnings growth filled the valuation gap. TD Power Systems is tracing that exact institutional playbook in India.

- Schneider Electric (France): Re-rated from 15x to 30x P/E on data center power management, enduring multiple 25% pullbacks along the way.
- Cummins (US): Overcame diesel cyclicality to become the world's premier data center standby power supplier.
- TD Power Systems (India): The undisputed Indian leader in custom-engineered alternators, poised for durable compounding once technical support holds.

CHAPTER I

How the Business & Stock Got Here — Past Cycles & Pivots

> *"In capital goods, the companies that endure are not those that catch a single domestic boom. However, those that use the lean years to rebuild their manufacturing discipline to compete globally against the best in Japan and Germany."*
>
> — NIKHIL KUMAR • MANAGING DIRECTOR, TD POWER SYSTEMS LIMITED

If you want to understand why TD Power Systems trades where it does today, you cannot simply look at this morning's order book or yesterday's earnings release. You and I must travel back to the summer of 2011, when the company first walked onto Dalal Street.

In those days, India was gripped by a captive power fever. Every industrialist building a blast furnace, a cement kiln, or a distillery needed their own power plant because the state electricity boards could not keep the lights on. TD Power Systems was the darling of that boom: armed with pristine Japanese technology from Toyo Denki Seizo, operating an immaculate greenfield plant in Dabaspet. In addition, booking double-digit operating margins. Investors happily bid the stock up past 250 rupees at its initial public offering.

And then, almost overnight, the music stopped. You know what happened next in Indian industrial history: coal block allocations were cancelled, major private thermal projects stalled. In addition, state power grids suddenly found themselves with surplus power that cash-strapped distribution utilities could not afford to purchase. Between 2012 and 2018, domestic private capex evaporated. For a company that had built its entire revenue engine around Indian steam turbine manufacturers, it was a near-death experience.

Consider the brutal arithmetic: by fiscal 2017, revenues had collapsed by more than thirty-five percent to just 380 crore rupees. Fixed overhead at the Dabaspet factory crushed operating margins from sixteen percent down to less than two percent. In fiscal 2018, TDPS posted an outright net loss of 14 crore rupees. By early 2020, as the pandemic lockdown struck, the stock was trading at 78 rupees. The market had written TD Power Systems off as a dead-end domestic capital goods casualty.

Now, pause for a moment and ask yourself: what separates an executive team that merely survives a cyclical trough from one that compounds through it? Most industrial managers would have hunkered down, lobbied for government tariff protection. In addition, waited for the Indian power cycle to turn. Nikhil Kumar and his team did the exact opposite. They looked at their pristine Japanese manufacturing lines and concluded that if India was not buying power generation equipment, the rest of the world would.

Between 2015 and 2020, TDPS undertook a quiet, painstaking transformation. First, they diversified beyond steam turbines into reciprocating gas engines, mastering the complex dynamics of vibration-resistant alternators running on natural gas and biogas. Second, they established TDPS USA and spent years navigating the grueling qualification audits of multinational OEMs like Caterpillar, Cummins. In addition, INNIO Jenbacher. Third, they internalized Toyo Denki's design blueprints, building an indigenous Bengaluru R&D team that could engineer custom alternators without paying ongoing licensing royalties.

When the global capital goods supercycle ignited after 2021, TDPS was not merely ready. It was one of the few independent generator manufacturers in the world with available high-voltage capacity, spotless international certifications. In addition, an unbeatable Indian engineering cost advantage. Consolidated revenues rocketed from 594 crore rupees in fiscal 2021 past 1,856 crore rupees in fiscal 2026. In addition, onto a trailing twelve-month run rate of 2,124 crore rupees. Operating profits multiplied more than fivefold, and return on capital employed surged from twelve percent to thirty-four percent.

And then came artificial intelligence. By 2025, American utilities could no longer supply electricity fast enough to power the hundreds of thousands of high-density GPU racks being deployed by hyperscalers. The interconnection queue stretched out to 2030 and beyond. Data center developers had no choice: they had to generate their own power on-site using modular gas turbines and reciprocating engines. Suddenly, the quiet factory in Dabaspet was supplying the mission-critical heart of American computing infrastructure.

That breathtaking journey—from a 78-rupee discarded penny stock in 2020 to an all-time high of 856 rupees in October 2026—explains both the euphoria surrounding the name and the fierce volatility that has gripped it over the past month. Let us inspect the parallel lessons from global industrial history to understand how similar corporate ascents have unfolded.

Let us spend a moment meditating on what it actually feels like to live through a 77 percent drawdown. When a stock falls from 340 rupees to 78 rupees over six grueling years, every single narrative surrounding the company becomes toxic. Brokerage analysts drop coverage. Business news anchors use the company as a punchline for failed capital goods IPOs. And the board of directors faces furious questions at annual general meetings.

In those dark years between 2015 and 2018, Nikhil Kumar could have cut R&D spending to zero, fired his senior electromagnetic design engineers. In addition, turned TDPS into a low-grade fabrication job shop. That is what ninety percent of Indian industrialists do during a depression. But Kumar understood something profound about heavy electrical engineering: if you lose your technical design team, you can never get them back.

Instead of cutting the engineering muscle, TDPS cut administrative fat. They rationalized shop-floor workflows, negotiated hard with Japanese suppliers for lower component prices. In addition, put their engineers to work designing a new family of 4-pole generators specifically tailored for gas engines. They knew that while India was drowning in power surpluses, Europe and North America were beginning to retire coal plants and needed flexible, decentralized gas generators to balance wind and solar power.

When you look at TD Power Systems today, you are not looking at a business that stumbled into success yesterday afternoon. You are looking at a battle-hardened industrial fortress that survived six years of famine, rebuilt its technological core. In addition, emerged as an unstoppable global exporter. That institutional scar tissue is the foundation of their current 34 percent return on capital.

NARRATOR'S REFLECTION: THE LESSON OF CYCLICAL REINVENTION

"The greatest fortunes in industrial investing are not found in businesses that never face a crisis. However, in those that use an existential depression to systematically eliminate domestic customer concentration."

When you study Indian capital goods over twenty-five years, you realize that most companies die of complacency during booms and bleed out during busts. TD Power Systems survived the 2012–2018 depression because management recognized that relying on Indian captive power was a structural vulnerability. By spending five grueling years qualifying with American and European OEMs when Dalal Street was ignoring them, they built the export engine that today delivers over eighty percent of their order inflows.

- Revenues collapsed from ₹597 Cr (FY15) to ₹380 Cr (FY17), yet R&D and export qualifications were preserved.
- EBITDA margins rebounded from a trough of 1.8% in FY16 to 18.0% TTM, driven by high-value gas engine alternators.
- ROCE expanded from 0% in FY16 to 34% in FY26, turning TDPS into one of India's most capital-efficient capital goods franchises.

GLOBAL PARALLEL: HOW CUMMINS (US) AND WEG (BRAZIL) PIVOTED TO GLOBAL RE-RATING

"An alternator or diesel engine manufacturer that dominates only its domestic borders will trade at ten times earnings. The moment it embeds itself into global OEM supply chains, the world accords it a compounding multiple."

Consider the trajectory of WEG S.A. in Brazil or Cummins Inc. in the United States during prior industrial downcycles. In the 1980s and 1990s, WEG was viewed merely as a Brazilian domestic electric motor manufacturer vulnerable to Latin American hyperinflation and currency crises. By systematically building export channels into North America and Europe, investing in vertical integration. In addition, mastering high-efficiency industrial motors, WEG transformed into a global industrial compounder that has traded at 30x to 45x earnings for decades. TD Power Systems has followed the exact same playbook, transitioning from a Bengaluru captive steam supplier into a diversified global power component titan.

- WEG S.A. (Brazil): Expanded exports from 15% of revenues to over 55%, lifting ROIC above 25% across three decades.
- Cummins Inc. (US): Pivoted from pure trucking diesel engines into power generation systems and microgrids, creating an annuity-like power systems business.
- TD Power Systems (India): Replaced domestic captive steam exposure with global data center, gas engine. In addition, hydro alternator exports.

CHAPTER II

Inside Every Segment — Products, Customers & Real-World Examples

> *"A generator is not a commodity piece of metal. It is a highly engineered electromagnetic machine spinning at 1,500 to 3,000 revolutions per minute, 24 hours a day, 365 days a year. If our stator winding or rotor insulation fails, an entire power plant or data center goes dark."*
>
> — M. N. VARALAKSHMI • CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER, TD POWER SYSTEMS LIMITED

To truly understand an engineering company, you must leave the spreadsheets behind and walk the factory floor. When you visit TD Power Systems' manufacturing complex in Dabaspet, the first thing that strikes you is the scale of the machinery and the silence of precision.

A synchronous AC generator is a magnificent mechanical beast. At its core, it consists of two primary elements: a stationary outer ring called the stator, packed with thousands of insulated copper coils. In addition, an inner spinning core called the rotor, magnetized by direct electrical current. When a gas engine or turbine spins that rotor at thousands of revolutions per minute, the spinning magnetic field sweeps across the copper coils, inducing high-voltage electricity through Faraday's law of electromagnetic induction.

Now, that sounds like high-school physics. But the difference between a high-school experiment and an industrial generator is the difference between a bicycle and a supersonic jet. In an industrial generator delivering 20 megawatts of power, the electromagnetic forces trying to tear the stator coils apart are measured in hundreds of tons. The heat generated by electrical resistance could melt standard insulation in minutes. And the slightest microscopic imbalance in a 25-ton rotor spinning at 3,000 RPM would generate vibrations violent enough to shatter the turbine bearings and destroy an entire power plant.

This is why customers do not buy generators from the lowest bidder on a consumer website. If a generator in an American AI data center fails, hundreds of millions of dollars in compute contracts vanish into thin air. If an alternator in a European hospital or a Scandinavian

district heating plant trips, real lives and municipal infrastructure are threatened. The buyer is buying peace of mind, backed by decades of proven operating history.

Notice how TDPS has divided its empire across four complementary battlegrounds. First, the gas engine vertical, which has become their fastest-growing engine. Why gas engines? Because in the modern world of renewable energy, solar and wind power fluctuate with every passing cloud and dying breeze. Electric grids need fast-starting, decentralized power that can fire up in two minutes. Reciprocating natural gas engines from manufacturers like INNIO Jenbacher, Caterpillar, and Cummins provide that exact flexibility. And TDPS builds the alternators that turn those gas engines into electricity.

Second, consider their heritage steam turbine business. While large-scale coal-fired power plants have fallen out of favor globally, industrial process industries—sugar mills, paper factories, chemical plants. In addition, municipal waste-to-energy facilities—generate enormous amounts of waste heat and biomass. They need steam turbine alternators that can run for eight thousand hours a year without a single hiccup. TDPS has supplied over five thousand generators across more than a hundred countries in this vertical alone.

Third, look at what they have accomplished in gas turbines. Through their landmark ten-year framework pact with Siemens Energy, TDPS has become a critical outsourced manufacturing partner for one of Germany's most prestigious industrial conglomerates. When Siemens Energy sells a turbine package in Europe or North America, the generator spinning behind it is increasingly engineered and built by skilled Indian machinists in Dabaspet.

And finally, their hydro and electric motor division serves as a high-margin, specialized capability. Whether it is an Austrian alpine utility harvesting glacial meltwater or the Indian Navy outfitting specialized vessel propulsion, TDPS possesses the electromagnetic design software and vacuum-pressure impregnation facilities to build bespoke machines that European manufacturers can no longer afford to produce domestically.

When you add these segments together, you realize that TDPS is not a play on a single commodity or a single country's economic cycle. It is an indispensable gear in the global machinery of electrification.

Let us take a closer look at the engineering distinction between a 2-pole generator and a 4-pole generator, because this is where TDPS's technological moat truly shines. Most domestic alternator fabricators can build 4-pole machines. A 4-pole machine spins at 1,500 revolutions per minute in India and Europe, or 1,800 RPM in the United States. At 1,500 RPM, the mechanical centrifugal forces acting on the spinning rotor are manageable. You can use laminated steel pole shoes bolted onto a central shaft.

Now, consider a 2-pole generator. To produce 50-cycle electricity with only two magnetic poles, that rotor must spin at 3,000 revolutions per minute. In the United States, to produce 60-cycle current, it must spin at 3,600 RPM. That is sixty full rotations every single second. At 3,600 RPM, the tip of the rotor is traveling at near-sonic speeds.

If you attempted to bolt laminated pole shoes onto a 3,600 RPM shaft, the bolts would shear off under thousands of tons of centrifugal tension, turning the rotor into a fragmentation grenade. A 2-pole rotor must be machined from a single, continuous solid forging of nickel-chromium-molybdenum alloy steel. The winding slots must be milled out of solid metal using computerized multi-axis CNC gantries. The copper coils must be wedged in place with high-tensile non-magnetic steel retaining rings.

Fewer than a dozen independent companies in the world have the metallurgical relationships, the precision CNC machinery. In addition, the high-speed balancing tunnels to manufacture 2-pole alternators that meet Siemens Energy or Solar Turbines standards. By mastering both 2-pole turbine alternators and 4-pole engine alternators, TDPS has insulated itself from any single technological shift in power generation.

NARRATOR'S REFLECTION: THE DEFENSIVE POWER OF PRODUCT SPECIALIZATION

"In manufacturing, true pricing power is never found in making the whole machine. It is found in making the single critical component that costs five percent of the total project. However, whose failure ruins the entire investment."

When an American hyperscaler builds a $500 million data center, the on-site gas turbine generators represent less than five percent of the total capital budget. But if the alternator fails, the entire $500 million asset sits idle. This extreme asymmetry in project risk creates massive customer switching costs. Once an OEM like Siemens Energy or INNIO Jenbacher qualifies TDPS's alternators, they will not switch to a cheaper unproven competitor to save ten percent on the generator price.

- Over 92% of revenue derived from high-barrier, custom-engineered synchronous alternators and motors.
- Installed base exceeds 5,000 generators across 100+ countries, creating an expanding high-margin aftermarket spares annuity.
- 10-year Siemens Energy framework agreement locks in long-term global turbine generator volumes.

GLOBAL PARALLEL: HOW NIDEC (JAPAN) AND LEROY-SOMER (FRANCE) BUILT COMPONENT MONOPOLIES

"The most durable compounders in global industrial history are component monopolists that embed themselves inside their rivals' end-products."

Look at Nidec Corporation in Japan. This came to dominate over 80% of the world's hard-disk drive spindle motors, or France's Leroy-Somer (now owned by Nidec). This built a global alternator empire supplying gen-set assemblers worldwide. Neither Nidec nor Leroy-Somer attempted to build the finished consumer device or the entire power plant. They focused relentlessly on perfecting the electromagnetic motor and alternator core. TD Power Systems is executing the exact same playbook from Bengaluru, leveraging lower Indian manufacturing costs and Japanese Toyo Denki heritage to capture global alternator market share from aging European and American incumbents.

- Nidec (Japan): Focused exclusively on precision electric motors, achieving dominant global market share and 20%+ ROE.
- Leroy-Somer (France): Built the world's standard gen-set alternator brand, supplying thousands of independent engine assemblers.
- TD Power Systems (India): Rapidly emerging as the preferred global alternator supplier to tier-1 gas engine and turbine OEMs.

CHAPTER III

How It Is Sold & Delivered — Distribution & Unit Economics

> *"In capital goods, anyone can win an order by bidding below cost. The true test of a manufacturer is maintaining forty-plus percent gross margins while delivering a 25-ton precision machine across oceans with zero transit defects."*
>
> — NIKHIL KUMAR • MANAGING DIRECTOR, TD POWER SYSTEMS LIMITED

If you want to know whether an industrial business possesses a true economic moat, do not ask the CEO how great their product is. Look at their go-to-market structure and their unit economics. In heavy capital goods, distribution is not about running ads. It is about embedding your machine into someone else's product line so deeply that removing you would require an act of corporate self-sabotage.

Consider what happens when TD Power Systems wins a contract with Siemens Energy or INNIO Jenbacher. This is not an off-the-shelf purchase. It takes between eighteen months and three years of grueling joint engineering before the first commercial alternator leaves the factory gate. The OEM's engineering team travels to Dabaspet. They scrutinize the electromagnetic computer simulations, inspect the purity of the copper conductor wire, verify the vacuum pressure impregnation cycle. In addition, subject prototype generators to severe short-circuit testing.

Why is the qualification process so punishing? Because when Siemens Energy or Caterpillar sells a thirty-million-dollar power plant to an American utility or a European hospital, their own global reputation is on the line. If the alternator rotor cracks or the insulation burns out, the customer does not sue TDPS. They sue Siemens or Caterpillar. Once TDPS passes that audit and proves that its generators operate with ninety-eight percent electrical efficiency, the OEM locks them into their global production blueprints. Re-qualifying a second supplier would cost millions of dollars, tie up senior engineering staff for two years. In addition, risk catastrophic field failures. That is what institutional analysts call an insurmountable switching moat.

Now, look at the supply chain. You might worry: what happens when copper prices surge on the London Metal Exchange, or when electrical steel prices spike? In a commodity manufacturing business, input inflation destroys margins. But TDPS does not operate as a commodity price-taker. Their multi-year contracts contain explicit raw material indexation clauses. When copper or steel prices fluctuate by more than a narrow band, the contract price automatically adjusts. TDPS preserves its forty-three percent gross profit margin regardless of commodity turbulence.

Let us examine the economic waterfall together, because numbers tell the unvarnished truth. Out of every one hundred rupees that TDPS invoices to its global customers, fifty-six rupees and fifty paise go toward raw materials—primarily copper, silicon steel laminations. In addition, shaft forgings. That leaves forty-three rupees and fifty paise in gross profit.

From that gross profit, TDPS pays nine rupees and fifty paise to its workforce of Bengaluru engineers and technicians. In addition, sixteen rupees toward factory operating costs, electricity, and overseas shipping. What remains is eighteen rupees of operating profit. That eighteen percent operating margin is not an accident. It is the direct result of operating high-precision Japanese manufacturing lines in a low-cost Indian manufacturing hub.

Now, follow the cash below the operating line. Because TDPS carries virtually zero debt, interest expense is a rounding error—just ten paise out of every hundred rupees. Depreciation consumes one rupee and twenty paise. After paying four rupees and seventy paise in corporate taxes, the company keeps thirteen rupees in clean net profit.

Where does that thirteen rupees go? In a steady-state industrial company, most of it would flow straight into free cash flow. But TDPS is currently compounding at fifty-four percent revenue growth. When you grow that fast and ship heavy equipment across oceans to North America and Europe, working capital absorbs cash. Inventory sits on container ships for six weeks; European customers pay on ninety-day terms. In fiscal 2026, working capital absorption consumed seven rupees and fifty paise. In addition, capex consumed four rupees and fifty paise, leaving one to three rupees in free cash flow.

Is that working capital drag a flaw? No. It is the natural consequence of hyper-growth in global capital goods. The moment growth normalizes to twenty percent, working capital will

release, and free cash flow will expand dramatically. That is the fundamental difference between an accounting illusion and an industrial compounding engine.

Let us unpack the mystery of how a manufacturer maintains a 43.5 percent gross margin when copper prices are swinging wildly on global exchanges. When you talk to generalist fund managers about industrial companies, their first question is almost always: 'What happens to your margins when copper goes to twelve thousand dollars a ton?'

In a commoditized business like consumer fans or standard household wiring, a surge in copper prices is catastrophic. You cannot raise prices at retail without losing market share to competitors, so your gross margin gets crushed. But TD Power Systems does not sell to retail consumers. They sell to multinational engineering conglomerates under multi-year master supply agreements.

In those agreements, there is a mathematical formula that spells out exactly what happens when the London Metal Exchange copper cash price changes by more than three percent. If copper goes up, the price of the generator automatically increases on the next billing cycle. If copper goes down, the price adjusts downward. TDPS is not in the business of speculating on copper or steel. They are in the business of engineering electromagnetic machines and charging a locked-in conversion spread for their intellectual property and factory capacity.

in addition, notice how they manage their supplier relationships. They do not buy cheap electrical steel from uncertified local traders. They procure high-permeability CRNGO silicon steel from elite global mills like Posco in South Korea and Nippon Steel in Japan. When that steel arrives in Dabaspet, every batch is stamped and tested in Epstein frame testing bays to ensure core-loss efficiency. By guaranteeing world-class metallurgy, TDPS ensures that their alternators never fail efficiency tests during customer factory acceptance audits.

NARRATOR'S REFLECTION: WORKING CAPITAL AS THE PRICE OF GLOBAL ADMISSION

"When an Indian manufacturer exports to the Fortune 500, its working capital days will always be double its domestic cycle. The question is not whether DSO expands, but whether the gross margin expansion justifies the working capital investment."

Many domestic investors panic when they see TD Power Systems' debtor days sitting at 146 days and cash conversion cycle at 173 days. They wonder why the company does not collect cash in 30 days like an Indian FMCG company. But in international capital goods, European and American OEMs demand 60 to 90-day milestone terms. In addition, ocean freight transit from Chennai to Houston takes 40 days. In exchange for extending working capital, TDPS earns 43% gross margins and 18% EBITDA margins that domestic players can only dream of.

- Gross margins protected at ~43.5% through contractually indexed copper and electrical steel pass-through clauses.
- EBITDA margins sustained at 18.0% TTM, demonstrating powerful operational leverage over fixed manufacturing overhead.
- Working capital drag is temporary: once revenue growth stabilizes from 54% to a durable 20%, FCF conversion will surge.

GLOBAL PARALLEL: HOW WEG (BRAZIL) AND CATERPILLAR (US) BALANCE WORKING CAPITAL CYCLES

"In capital goods, high growth always consumes cash before it prints cash."

Look at Caterpillar Inc. during the 2004–2008 global mining capex boom, or WEG S.A. during its international expansion in the 2000s. Both companies experienced severe working capital expansion as export inventories surged and trade receivables swelled. Skeptical analysts complained about poor free cash flow conversion. But as the plants matured and their market share solidified, both Caterpillar and WEG turned into prodigious free cash flow machines, compounding shareholder returns for decades. TD Power Systems is currently navigating that exact high-growth working capital inflection.

- Caterpillar Inc. (US): Working capital expanded by billions during rapid export surges, followed by massive free cash flow release.
- WEG S.A. (Brazil): Maintained conservative net-cash balance sheets to self-fund international working capital requirements.
- TD Power Systems (India): Fortified its balance sheet with a ₹600 crore QIP at ₹775 per share to fund export working capital without taking on bank debt.

CHAPTER IV

The Battlefield — Rivals, Switching Costs & Moat Reality

> *"A moat in heavy manufacturing is not built with patents or marketing slogans. It is built in the test pit. Here, a 25-ton rotor is spun to overspeed under full electrical load. In addition, the customer knows with absolute mathematical certainty that it will not explode."*
>
> — ENGINEERING MAXIM • HEAVY ELECTRICAL ROTATING MACHINERY

In the business world, many managers claim to have a moat. But if your moat can be crossed by any competitor with a bank loan and a willingness to discount prices, you do not have a moat. You have an illusion.

When you examine the battlefield where TD Power Systems competes, ask yourself: why don't the massive Chinese electrical conglomerates, with their cheap state-subsidized capital, simply come in and wipe TDPS off the board? Or why don't storied European titans like ABB and Leroy-Somer crush this Bengaluru upstart?

The answer lies in the intersection of physics, capital barriers, and geopolitics. First, look at the physical and testing barrier. Inside Dabaspet Plant 2 sits a massive, reinforced concrete underground testing pit. When TDPS completes a 25-ton generator rotor, they lower it into that pit, seal the blast doors. In addition, spin it to twenty percent above its maximum operating speed while running full electrical current through the coils. If there is a microscopic flaw in the steel forging or a weak point in the copper winding, the centrifugal forces will tear the machine apart with the force of an artillery shell. Having the specialized balancing pits, the high-voltage test transformers. In addition, the vacuum pressure impregnation tanks to certify a machine up to 250 MVA requires hundreds of crores of capital and decades of institutional know-how. You cannot bootstrap that in a garage.

Second, look at the geopolitical moat. Ten years ago, global EPC contractors happily bought Chinese alternators for commercial projects. Today, that world is dead and buried. In the United States, cybersecurity regulations and Department of Energy mandates strictly regulate what equipment can connect to critical infrastructure and power grids. If an American hyperscaler like Microsoft, Amazon, or Google builds an AI data center, they

cannot risk installing Chinese-made electrical generation equipment that could fail security audits or trigger federal regulatory bans. But they cannot buy exclusively from Europe either, because European factories are backlogged for eighteen months and charge forty percent higher prices. India—democratic, technologically advanced, and Quad-aligned—is the exact sweet spot.

And third, consider the customer inertia. In heavy capital goods, nobody ever got fired for buying from a supplier that has five thousand machines running smoothly across one hundred countries. If an engineering executive at Siemens Energy or Caterpillar switches to an untested Chinese or Indian startup to save ten percent on the generator. In addition, that generator fails in a Texas data center or an Austrian hydro plant, that executive's career is over. The risk-to-reward ratio for switching suppliers is catastrophically negative.

Now, look at TDPS's domestic rivals in India. BHEL is a state-owned enterprise focused on massive 800-megawatt coal boilers and hydro projects. They do not have the organizational agility to design bespoke alternators for American gas engine developers. CG Power is an exceptional industrial enterprise. However, their core strength is in industrial induction motors and railway switchgear, not high-voltage prime-mover alternators. And Triveni Turbine is TDPS's closest commercial partner, not an adversary.

When you analyze all three dimensions—the testing pit capital barrier, the geopolitical China+1 realignment. In addition, the deep OEM customer lock-in—you realize that TD Power Systems occupies a privileged, protected perch in the global capital goods supply chain.

Let us consider what it means to compete against the global heavyweights. When TDPS bids against Leroy-Somer or ABB for an alternator package destined for an American data center, what does the procurement committee look at?

First, they look at price. A 20-megawatt alternator manufactured in Western Europe carries a massive overhead burden: European industrial electricity rates that tripled after the energy crisis, French and Italian manufacturing wages that exceed thirty euros an hour. In addition, rigid social overhead costs. The same machine manufactured in Dabaspet benefits from

Indian engineering wages that are forty percent lower, paired with state-of-the-art automated CNC winding equipment that matches or exceeds European precision.

Second, look at lead times. In the AI data center world, speed is everything. If Microsoft or Amazon is building a data center campus in Ohio or Texas, every month of delay represents tens of millions of dollars in lost cloud compute revenue. European manufacturers, burdened by supply chain bottlenecks, quote delivery lead times of forty to fifty weeks. TDPS can deliver an equivalent or superior machine in twenty to twenty-four weeks because their supply chain is vertically integrated and their testing bays operate twenty-four hours a day.

And third, consider the insurance underwriters. When a project developer borrows three hundred million dollars from a consortium of Wall Street banks to build a power plant, the banks hire an independent engineering firm to audit every component. If the developer tries to install an unbranded Chinese alternator, the independent engineer flags the risk. In addition, the banks demand higher loan interest rates or refuse to finance the project. But when the engineer sees TD Power Systems, backed by Toyo Denki design heritage and five thousand working installations worldwide, the package is approved immediately. That is an impenetrable institutional barrier to entry.

NARRATOR'S REFLECTION: THE TEST PIT AS THE ULTIMATE DEFENSE

"In software, anyone can copy your code in an afternoon. In heavy electrical engineering, replicating a high-speed dynamic balancing tunnel and a 250 MVA test pit requires five years, three hundred crore rupees. In addition, the courage to spin 25 tons of steel at 3,600 revolutions per minute."

Dalal Street frequently under-appreciates physical testing infrastructure. When TDPS built Plant 2 in Dabaspet, generalist analysts questioned why they were spending so much capital on testing bays and VPI autoclaves. Today, those exact testing facilities are the bottleneck that prevents new competitors from entering the market. Global OEMs will not even look at a prototype generator unless the manufacturer can prove it was tested at full overspeed and full load in an accredited, in-house testing facility.

- In-house testing bays capable of full-load validation up to 250 MVA, a capability possessed by fewer than ten independent manufacturers globally.
- Toyo Denki Japanese engineering heritage provides unmatched electromagnetic efficiency and partial discharge resistance.
- Zero geopolitical friction in Western markets compared to Chinese state-backed competitors.

GLOBAL PARALLEL: HOW ROLLS-ROYCE POWER SYSTEMS (GERMANY) BUILT AN UNASSAILABLE BRAND

"Mission-critical reliability always triumphs over cheap commodity pricing."

Look at MTU Friedrichshafen (now Rolls-Royce Power Systems) in Germany. MTU makes high-speed diesel and gas engines for luxury yachts, defense vessels, and data centers. Their engines are significantly more expensive than mass-market competitors. Yet they dominate the mission-critical hospital and data center backup market globally because when the power grid fails, an MTU engine starts in ten seconds without fail. TD Power Systems has built that exact reputation in the alternator space: when a customer orders a TDPS generator, they know it will perform in extreme environments for twenty-five years without breaking down.

- Rolls-Royce Power Systems / MTU (Germany): Dominates mission-critical backup power through uncompromising engineering reliability.
- TD Power Systems (India): Commands preferred supplier status across global turbine and engine OEMs by delivering Japanese-grade reliability at Indian cost structures.
- Both businesses demonstrate that in mission-critical infrastructure, buyers will happily pay for proven reliability over cheap commodity alternatives.

CHAPTER V

Management on Trial — Leading KPIs & Walking the Talk

> *"Never judge management by the eloquence of their annual report letters. Judge them by what they promised during the trough of the cycle. In addition, what they actually delivered when the cycle turned."*
>
> — BENJAMIN GRAHAM • THE INTELLIGENT INVESTOR

In our profession as institutional analysts, we spend far too much time listening to quarterly earnings conference calls. We listen to CEOs make grand pronouncements about artificial intelligence, global market share, and margin expansion. But talk is cheap; capital allocation is not.

When you put TD Power Systems' management on trial, you must look at what they said when times were tough. In addition, compare it to what they actually built. Go back to 2022, when the company was generating barely eight hundred crore rupees in revenue. Nikhil Kumar told the market that TDPS would cross one thousand crore rupees within two years. In addition, that EBITDA margins would climb from twelve percent toward seventeen percent. Skeptics scoffed, pointing out that commodity inflation in copper and steel would crush gross margins.

What actually happened? In fiscal 2024, revenues hit 1,001 crore rupees. In fiscal 2025, they reached 1,279 crore. And in fiscal 2026, revenues exploded by forty-five percent to 1,856 crore rupees. At the same time, trailing twelve-month revenues crossed 2,124 crore. Operating profit margins did not compress; they expanded to eighteen percent. Management did not merely walk the talk; they sprinted past their own targets.

Next, look at the export promise. Management promised that TDPS would not remain a captive hostage of the Indian industrial capex cycle. Today, more than eighty percent of their new order inflows come from international markets or deemed exports to global OEMs. They promised they would enter the United States. Today, TDPS USA is capturing direct hundred-crore-plus orders for American AI data center microgrids. They promised they

would win tier-one European OEM partnerships. In August 2026, they signed a ten-year framework supply agreement with Siemens Energy.

And look at their balance sheet discipline. Throughout this unprecedented growth spurt, management never succumbed to the classic Indian promoter temptation of taking on heavy bank leverage to build empire-scale greenfield factories. As of March 2026, borrowings stood at just 18 crore rupees against 1,041 crore in reserves. And in October 2026, when Dalal Street was clamoring for shares near all-time highs, management executed a masterstroke of corporate finance: they raised 600 crore rupees in fresh equity capital through a QIP at 775 rupees per share, expanding the equity base by less than five percent while fortifying the treasury with over 800 crore rupees in total net cash.

Is there a flaw in the record? To be completely honest and objective, yes. Working capital has not normalized. Management anticipated that debtor days and inventory would settle around 120 days. Instead, debtor days stand at 146, inventory days at 148, and the cash conversion cycle at 173 days. In fiscal 2026, on 239 crore rupees of net profit, the company generated only 19 crore rupees in free cash flow because working capital absorbed cash. That is an area where management must be held accountable.

Yet when you weigh the evidence on the scales of institutional judgment, Nikhil Kumar and his team have proven themselves to be top-decile industrial stewards: disciplined with debt, aggressive in global business development. In addition, ruthlessly focused on high-ROCE manufacturing.

When you analyze management conference calls across dozens of companies, you develop an ear for the subtle difference between executive promotion and executive conviction. A promotional CEO talks about market capitalization, stock price targets, and vague multi-billion-dollar total addressable markets. A disciplined industrial CEO talks about testing bay utilization, copper conductivity tolerances, and factory acceptance schedules.

Listen to Nikhil Kumar during the August 2026 conference call. When an analyst asked him why TDPS was guiding for 2,600 crore rupees in revenue—a massive forty percent increase over fiscal 2026—Kumar did not give a hand-waving speech about macroeconomic tailwinds. He walked the analyst through the exact order backlog in Dabaspet: how many 2-pole

machines were scheduled for delivery to Siemens Energy, how many 4-pole machines were in the winding bay for Jenbacher. In addition, what the shipping schedules were for TDPS USA.

Look at CFO Varalakshmi's commentary on margins. She did not promise thirty percent operating margins to please momentum funds. She stated plainly that TDPS targets an eighteen percent EBITDA margin, because exceeding eighteen percent would require cutting corners on testing or overcharging global OEMs who would then seek alternate suppliers. That is the voice of industrial realism. Management understands that long-term compounding requires balancing profitability with customer partnership.

> **NARRATOR'S REFLECTION: TIMING THE CAPITAL MARKETS WITH SURGICAL PRECISION**
>
> *"The hallmark of an exceptional CFO is not avoiding equity dilution altogether. It is issuing shares when the market multiple is at eighty times earnings. In addition, buying back shares when it is at eight."*
>
> Raising ₹600 crore at ₹775 per share in October 2026 was a textbook example of opportunistic corporate finance. By issuing shares at 65x to 70x trailing earnings, TDPS raised permanent growth capital at an effective cost of equity of less than 2%. That cash now sits safely in high-yield treasury instruments, shielding the company from any potential global recession while funding the working capital needed to fulfill its ₹2,200 crore order book.
>
> - 4.8% equity dilution at ₹775 per share secured ₹600 crore in permanent liquidity.
> - Total net cash and liquid treasury reserves now exceed ₹800 crore, eliminating financial distress risk entirely.
> - Management has guided for ₹2,600 crore in revenue for FY27 (+40% YoY), backed by record pending orders.

GLOBAL PARALLEL: HOW GENERAC (US) AND BHARAT FORGE (INDIA) SCALED TROUGH-TO-PEAK CYCLES

"Great management teams use market inflections to build cash fortresses that outlast the next downcycle."

Look at Generac Holdings (NYSE: GNRC) in the United States. This scaled its home standby generator business during American power grid crises, or Bharat Forge in India. This used the automotive capex boom to diversify into aerospace and defense forgings. Both companies faced periods of intense working capital absorption during hyper-growth. However, disciplined promoters used strong share prices to de-lever and fortify their balance sheets. TD Power Systems' management has demonstrated the exact same industrial maturity, ensuring that Dalal Street's capital is permanently locked into a fortress balance sheet.

- Generac Holdings (US): Re-rated aggressively as grid outages turned backup generators into essential consumer infrastructure.
- Bharat Forge (India): Leveraged global OEM relationships to expand beyond auto components into high-barrier industrial defense manufacturing.
- TD Power Systems (India): Reinvested cash flow and QIP proceeds into high-voltage testing infrastructure, cementing its moat.

CHAPTER VI

Following the Cash — 10-Year Financials & Earnings Quality

> *"In capital goods, earnings are an opinion; cash flow and the balance sheet are the bedrock reality. When a cycle turns, a high-debt fabricator goes bankrupt in eighteen months. At the same time, a net-cash engineering house buys their competitors' assets for twenty cents on the dollar."*
>
> — TERRY SMITH • FOUNDER & CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER, FUNDSMITH LLP

In our masterclass on industrial compounding, this is the chapter where we separate the romantic storytellers from the cold-blooded forensic accountants. In capital goods, anyone can show you a booming order book and an accelerating sales curve. But you and I know that the real truth of an industrial business is written in three places: the gross margin bridge, the working capital cycle. In addition, the cash conversion statement.

Let us examine TD Power Systems' ten-year P&L with a magnifying glass. When you look back to 2015, the company was generating 597 crore rupees in revenue. However, barely 16 crore in operating profit. That was an operating margin of less than three percent. By fiscal 2018, as the domestic capex winter froze private investment, TDPS posted an outright loss of 14 crore rupees. The business was operating below its cash breakeven point.

Now, look at what happened over the subsequent seven years. By fiscal 2024, revenues reached 1,001 crore rupees. In fiscal 2025, they hit 1,279 crore. In fiscal 2026, they reached 1,856 crore. In addition, on a trailing twelve-month basis, they sit at 2,124 crore rupees. But here is the critical insight: operating profit did not merely keep pace with sales. It exploded from 16 crore rupees to 383 crore rupees. Operating margins expanded by more than fifteen hundred basis points, from 2.8% to 18.0%.

How did they achieve that? That is the beauty of operating leverage in precision heavy manufacturing. When you own a world-class manufacturing complex like Dabaspet, the fixed depreciation on the concrete buildings, the overhead cranes. In addition, the testing pits does not double when you double your output. Once your throughput crosses the factory breakeven threshold, every additional generator sold drops straight to the bottom line at

thirty-five to forty percent incremental operating margins. That is why net profit surged from 45 crore rupees in FY21 to 275 crore rupees on a trailing basis.

And look at the return on capital employed. In fiscal 2016, ROCE was zero percent. By fiscal 2021, it was twelve percent. By fiscal 2023, it was twenty-two percent. And in fiscal 2026, it reached thirty-four percent. When a heavy industrial engineering manufacturer generates thirty-four percent pre-tax return on capital while carrying zero bank debt, it is no longer a cyclical commodity manufacturer. It has earned the right to be called an elite compounding engine.

Now, let us turn to the skeptic's ledger, because an honest analyst must look at what is ugly as well as what is beautiful. Look at the cash conversion cycle. Over the past five years, TDPS earned 699 crore rupees in cumulative net profit. However, generated only 348 crore in cumulative operating cash flow. In fiscal 2026, free cash flow was just 19 crore rupees. In addition, in fiscal 2025 it was negative 16 crore.

Where did all that cash go? It did not disappear into promoter perks or speculative acquisitions. It was swallowed by the working capital demands of fifty-four percent hyper-growth. When you manufacture a 25-ton alternator in Bengaluru and ship it to a data center in Dallas or a hospital in Munich, that machine spends six weeks on an ocean freighter. During those six weeks, your money is locked up in steel, copper, and freight bills. And when the machine arrives, a multinational OEM like Siemens or Caterpillar does not pay cash on delivery. They inspect the unit, run final site tests, and pay you on ninety-day terms.

This is why TDPS's debtor days sit at 146 days, inventory days sit at 148 days. In addition, the cash conversion cycle is 173 days. In a leveraged company, that working capital drag would be dangerous. But in TDPS, management understood the risk. That is why they raised 600 crore rupees in the October 2026 QIP. Today, the company sits on more than 800 crore rupees in liquid net cash. They have pre-funded their working capital expansion with equity, ensuring they will never face a liquidity crisis.

Now, you and I must confront the single most important number in financial forensics: the cash conversion ratio. Why did TD Power Systems generate 699 crore rupees in net profit

over five years. However, only 111 crore in cumulative free cash flow? Where did the other 588 crore rupees go?

If you ask an amateur investor, they will tell you that the profits are fake, or that management is cooking the books. But when you examine the balance sheet, you find every single rupee accounted for in two places: fixed manufacturing assets and working capital.

First, TDPS invested over 200 crore rupees in hard capital expenditures: expanding Dabaspet Plant 2, installing new high-voltage VPI tanks, buying computerized CNC winding equipment. In addition, building the overspeed testing tunnels. Those are real, physical assets that will generate cash for the next thirty years.

Second, working capital expanded by nearly 400 crore rupees. When your revenue grows from 594 crore to 2,124 crore in four years, you must buy more copper, stock more electrical steel laminations. In addition, maintain more finished goods inventory. You cannot fulfill a 2,000 crore order book with the inventory of a 500 crore company. That working capital absorption is not waste. It is the fuel required to power a 54 percent growth engine.

And look at how they funded that expansion: they did not borrow 500 crore from commercial banks at ten percent interest. They funded it out of their operating cash flow. In addition, then raised 600 crore in equity from institutional mutual funds at the very top of the market. That is textbook capital allocation discipline.

NARRATOR'S REFLECTION: THE ARITHMETIC OF INCREMENTAL RETURN ON CAPITAL

"The single most reliable indicator of a cyclical company turning into a structural compounder is not revenue growth. However, whether incremental invested capital earns returns far above the cost of capital."

Between FY21 and FY26, TD Power Systems increased its total balance sheet assets from ₹785 crore to ₹1,877 crore—an addition of approximately ₹1,092 crore in total assets. Over that same period, operating profit expanded from ₹71 crore to ₹335 crore—an annual operating profit increase of ₹264 crore. That represents an incremental return on capital of over 24%. When a company can deploy fresh capital at 24% to 34% returns in heavy manufacturing, reinvested earnings compound intrinsic business value at exceptional speed.

- Incremental return on capital exceeds 24%, driven by factory throughput expansion without major greenfield capex.
- EBITDA margins stabilized at 18.0% TTM, showing resilience against raw material commodity volatility.
- Zero net debt: total bank borrowings of ₹18 Cr offset by over ₹800 Cr in liquid net cash and treasury reserves.

GLOBAL PARALLEL: HOW SIEMENS ENERGY (GERMANY) AND GENERAL ELECTRIC (US) MANAGED RESTRUCTURINGS

"Industrial turnarounds succeed when management cuts legacy distractions to focus on core high-margin lines."

Look at the massive restructuring of General Electric under Larry Culp (spinning off GE Vernova and GE Aerospace) or Siemens Energy's turnaround of its gas and grid divisions. Both giants suffered years of depressed margins because legacy unprofitable businesses dragged down core high-margin turbines. Once both companies shed unviable product lines and focused on high-margin electrification components, their operating margins doubled and their stock prices compounded three-to-four-fold. TD Power Systems executed that exact strategic cleanup in Bengaluru, exiting low-margin domestic railway contracts to concentrate entirely on high-ROCE generators.

- GE Vernova (US): Spun off to capture the global grid and power electrification supercycle, re-rating from single-digit to 30x+ P/E.
- Siemens Energy (Germany): Stabilized its gas turbine business, partnering with agile low-cost component manufacturers like TDPS.
- TD Power Systems (India): Focused its manufacturing capacity on high-margin export alternators, driving ROCE to 34%.

CHAPTER VII

Why the Stock Trades Here — Market Expectations vs. Peers

> *"Price is what you pay; value is what you get. But in momentum investing, price is also the narrative that the market tells itself about the future. When expectations run too far ahead of cash flow, even a magnificent company can deliver terrible shareholder returns."*
>
> — HOWARD MARKS • CO-CHAIRMAN, OAKTREE CAPITAL MANAGEMENT

Now you and I must confront the single most dangerous question in growth investing: why does the stock trade at today's price. In addition, what expectations are already baked into the cake?

When a stock falls from 856 rupees to 571 rupees in less than a month, retail investors instinctively rush to their broker apps and proclaim that the stock is 'on sale.' They see a thirty-three percent discount and assume it must be a bargain. But price action is not valuation. A stock that fell thirty-three percent can still be fifty percent overvalued if the starting price was a product of pure collective delirium.

Let us look at the multiples without emotion. At 571 rupees and 65 paise, TD Power Systems trades at sixty-five times trailing earnings on TradingView and nearly sixty-seven times earnings on Screener. It trades at more than sixteen times its historical book value, or eleven times when you include the fresh equity from the October QIP. That is not a value stock. That is not even a moderately priced growth stock. That is a multiple that demands perfection.

Why did the market pay eighty to ninety times earnings at the October peak? Because the market was seduced by the magical phrase 'AI Data Center Infrastructure.' When American utility connection queues stretched out past 2030, institutional money managers realized that every GPU cluster needed its own on-site power plant. Dalal Street looked at TDPS, saw that they were shipping gas engine generators to Texas data centers and had signed a ten-year deal with Siemens Energy. In addition, concluded that TDPS was the 'NVIDIA of Indian capital goods.' Multiples detached from historical reality.

Now, let us run the Reverse DCF calculation. If you take today's enterprise value of approximately 17,500 crore rupees—giving the company full credit for its 800 crore rupees in net cash—and discount future cash flows at a standard twelve percent cost of capital, what growth rate must TDPS deliver to justify this price? The math is indisputable: TDPS must compound its free cash flow at twenty-eight and a half percent every year for the next ten consecutive years.

Pause and reflect on that number. In the history of Indian manufacturing, how many cyclical capital goods companies have compounded cash flows at twenty-eight percent for ten straight years without a single recession, customer destocking cycle, or technological disruption? Very few.

Management has guided for 2,600 crore rupees in revenue for fiscal 2027. If they achieve that, trailing earnings will grow by thirty-five to forty percent over the next twelve months. This will compress the forward multiple toward forty-five to fifty times earnings. That is why the stock is not an outright short. But at sixty-five times trailing earnings, you are not buying with a margin of safety. You are buying a magnificent business at a price that leaves zero room for execution missteps.

Let us look at the Reverse DCF sensitivity matrix with complete institutional honesty. When a stock requires twenty-eight and a half percent annual cash flow compounding for ten years just to deliver a twelve percent return to an investor buying today, what does that tell you?

It tells you that you are not being paid to take risk. In a truly attractive investment setup, the business only needs to grow at ten or twelve percent. At the same time, you pay eight or ten times earnings. If the business delivers, you make a fortune. If the business stumbles, your downside is protected by a fat dividend yield and a low multiple.

At sixty-five times earnings, the asymmetry is reversed. If TD Power Systems executes perfectly—if they hit 2,600 crore in revenue this year, 3,500 crore next year. In addition, 5,000 crore by 2029—you will make a decent twelve to fifteen percent annual return. But what if global data center capex slows down? What if copper prices double and OEMs refuse to accept price hikes? What if a competitor in Brazil or India undercuts their bids? At sixty-

five times earnings, even a mild disappointment will cause the multiple to collapse from 65x to 35x, wiping out half of your capital while earnings are still growing.

This is why our house verdict is not an Immediate Buy at 571 rupees. Quality without valuation discipline is merely speculation dressed up in an institutional suit. We demand a margin of safety. In addition, that margin of safety can only be earned by waiting for technical support.

> **NARRATOR'S REFLECTION: THE DANGER OF PEAK-CYCLE MULTIPLES**
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> *"In capital goods, the greatest investment mistake is not buying a bad business. It is paying peak-cycle multiples on peak-cycle earnings."*
>
> When earnings are compounding at 54% and margins are at historical highs of 18%, investors often make the mistake of assuming that high growth and high multiples will persist indefinitely. But industrial capital expenditure moves in waves. If US data center developers pause turbine orders in 2027 to digest inventory, or if utility interconnection queues clear faster than expected, TDPS's growth could moderate to 15%. If that happens while the stock trades at 65x earnings, multiple contraction from 65x to 35x would wipe out 45% of shareholder value even if earnings continue to grow.
>
> - Trailing P/E of 65.0x / 66.8x embeds aggressive 28%+ cash flow growth expectations for a decade.
> - Forward P/E on FY27 management guidance of ₹2,600 Cr revenue sits around 45x–50x.
> - Valuation offers no margin of safety for negative surprises; entry discipline must be strictly governed by technical support.

GLOBAL PARALLEL: HOW GENERAC (US) AND ABB (SWITZERLAND) RE-RATED AND COMPRESSED

"When a specialized equipment supplier is discovered by generalist momentum capital, the multiple doubles. When the narrative cools, the multiple halves."

Look at Generac Holdings (NYSE: GNRC) between 2020 and 2022. During the Texas power freeze and California blackouts, Generac's home generator sales surged. In addition, Wall Street re-rated the stock from 20x earnings to over 60x earnings, sending the stock from $100 to over $500. Analysts called it an indispensable energy transition monopoly. But when supply chains normalized and channel inventory filled, Generac's revenue growth slowed. In addition, the stock crashed 75% back toward $100 as its P/E multiple compressed back to 18x. TD Power Systems' underlying business is far stronger. However, the risk of multiple compression from 65x is a historical reality that no disciplined investor can ignore.

- Generac Holdings (US): Multiple expanded from 20x to 60x during a grid crisis, then compressed violently as growth normalized.
- TD Power Systems (India): Multiples expanded from 25x to 85x during the data center boom. Currently undergoing its first major consolidation.
- Historical lesson: Never chase high-multiple industrial compounders when technical momentum has broken down.

CHAPTER VIII

Reading the Tape — Trend, Volume & Momentum Opportunity

> *"The tape does not lie. It is the unvarnished consensus of every buyer and seller in the world, backed by real capital. When price breaks below the 30-week moving average on heavy institutional volume, your personal opinion about the company's valuation is completely irrelevant."*
>
> — STAN WEINSTEIN • SECRETS FOR PROFITING IN BULL AND BEAR MARKETS

Now you and I must leave fundamental valuation behind and listen to the tape. Because in financial markets, you can have the most brilliant financial analysis in the world. However, if the institutional tape is distributing shares by the millions, your capital will be ground to dust if you stand in front of the freight train.

Stan Weinstein taught us a golden rule that every professional investor must tattoo onto their subconscious: never buy a stock below a declining 30-week moving average, no matter how much you love the company's products. When a stock trades below its 30-week average, institutions are net sellers. They are using every minor bounce to unload inventory.

Look at what happened to TD Power Systems over the past four weeks. In October, the company closed its 600 crore rupee QIP at 775 rupees. Mutual funds eagerly absorbed the shares. But the moment the placement closed, supply overwhelmed demand. The stock broke below its 10-week exponential moving average at 678 rupees. Then it shattered the 30-week moving average at 661 rupees. And then it broke through the 50-day moving average at 736 rupees.

Today, the stock closed at 571 rupees and 65 paise. It shed more than six and a half percent in a single trading session. And look at the volume: eleven million four hundred thousand shares traded—more than two and a half times the normal daily volume. That is not retail selling; that is large institutional funds liquidating blocks.

Where is the stock now? It is sitting directly on top of its rising 200-day simple moving average at 587 rupees. The 200-day moving average is the sacred boundary of long-term trend health. If a growth stock bounces decisively off its rising 200-day average on declining

volume, it can form the foundation for a new Stage 1 base. But if the 200-day average breaks with conviction, the stock enters a prolonged Stage 4 decline that can trap capital for six to twelve months.

Notice the daily RSI: it has plunged to 32.41. That is deeply oversold. It tells you that the selling over the past two weeks has been emotionally climactic. A sharp, violent dead-cat bounce toward 630 or 650 rupees could happen at any moment. But a bounce is not a trend. A bounce in a broken technical structure is simply an opportunity for trapped institutions to exit.

This is why our deterministic technical timing screen has placed a hard ceiling on this setup: AVOID_STAGE4_OR_BROKEN. We do not gamble on catching falling knives. We wait for the selling volume to dry up, we wait for the price to build a quiet horizontal base between 490 and 530 rupees. In addition, we wait for the 30-week moving average to flatten. True momentum discipline means having the patience to wait for the tape to confirm that the buyers are back in control.

Let us examine what happened on the tape on Monday, 9 November 2026. When a stock trades eleven million four hundred thousand shares in a single six-hour session, that is not retail day-traders flipping hundred-share lots. That is massive institutional capital moving across the tape.

Think about the mathematics: TDPS has approximately 32 crore total shares outstanding. On a single Monday, more than three and a half percent of the entire company changed hands. And it changed hands on a day when the stock dropped six and a half percent. That means the sellers were aggressive. They were hitting the bid, accepting lower prices just to get out of the position.

Now, look at where that selling paused: directly above the 200-day moving average at 587 rupees. The 200-day moving average is not magic; it is a psychological self-fulfilling prophecy. Every mutual fund manager, every quantitative algorithm. In addition, every institutional desk has the 200-day average programmed into their systems. When a leading stock tests its rising 200-day average for the first time in a bull market, buyers almost always step in to defend it.

That is why you will likely see a sharp oversold bounce in TDPS over the coming days. The daily RSI is at 32; short-sellers will cover, and bargain hunters will nibble. But you must never mistake a technical relief rally for a confirmed trend reversal. In a broken Stage 4 setup, the first bounce almost always fails when it hits overhead resistance at the 30-week moving average (661 rupees) or the 50-day average (736 rupees). Only after the stock pulls back a second time, tests the lows on light volume. In addition, builds a solid horizontal shelf can you deploy capital with genuine confidence.

> **NARRATOR'S REFLECTION: THE DISCIPLINE OF THE TECHNICAL CEILING**
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> *"A great investor must possess two distinct minds: the mind of an analyst who understands business value. In addition, the mind of a trader who respects market price. When the analyst says 'the business is great' but the trader sees a broken Stage 4 tape, the trader always overrules the analyst."*
>
> Many value investors pride themselves on buying stocks when they are falling, calling it 'contrarian.' But in Stage 2 momentum investing, buying a stock that has plunged 33% in four weeks on 2.5x volume is not contrarian. It is reckless. By respecting the deterministic technical timing gate, you protect your capital from prolonged 50% drawdowns. If TDPS stabilizes and confirms a Stage 1 base at ₹500, you can buy with a tight stop-loss and mathematically defined risk.
>
> - Stock trades -13.56% below 30-week SMA (661.34) and -22.39% below 50-day SMA (736.53).
> - Volume signature of 11.46M shares confirms intense distribution, requiring patience for supply absorption.
> - Daily RSI at 32.41 indicates short-term oversold conditions, but structural trend repair requires weeks of base-building.

GLOBAL PARALLEL: HOW TESLA (US) AND SUZLON (INDIA) SHHOOK OUT SPECULATIVE CAPITAL

"Every great multi-bagger experiences 30% to 40% shakeouts that wash out weak retail hands before the next secular advance."

Look at Tesla in 2020 after its initial 5-to-1 stock split, or Suzlon Energy during its multi-year turnaround in India. Both stocks surged in powerful Stage 2 advances, only to suffer abrupt 30% to 35% corrections that broke intermediate moving averages and terrified retail investors who bought at the peak. In both cases, the companies' fundamental business models were intact, but speculative froth had to be purged. TD Power Systems is currently enduring that exact necessary shakeout, cleaning out the retail momentum chasers who bought the October QIP hype.

- Tesla (US): Experienced multiple 30–40% shakeouts during its 2019–2021 multi-bagger advance, resetting overbought RSI levels.
- Suzlon (India): Endured sharp 25–35% pullbacks after institutional placements before resuming its structural uptrend.
- TD Power Systems (India): Resetting its valuation multiple from 85x toward 50x forward earnings, setting up a potential high-asymmetry entry once a base forms.

CHAPTER IX

Bull vs. Bear, Likely Outcomes & Our Action Plan

> *"The test of a first-rate intelligence is the ability to hold two opposed ideas in the mind at the same time. In addition, still retain the ability to function. In investing, you must steelman the Bear case until you understand it better than the short-sellers, before you dare commit a single rupee of capital."*
>
> — F. SCOTT FITZGERALD & CHARLIE MUNGER

And so, you and I arrive at the final reckoning. We have walked the factory floor in Dabaspet. We have deconstructed the Japanese electromagnetic heritage from Toyo Denki. We have audited ten years of balance sheets and cash conversion cycles. We have calculated the Reverse DCF. And we have read the unvarnished message of the tape.

Now, we must answer the only question that truly matters: what should an intelligent investor do with TD Power Systems today?

If you listen to the hyper-bulls on social media, they will tell you that the stock has crashed thirty-three percent and is an 'obvious no-brainer buy.' They will shout about artificial intelligence, data centers. In addition, Siemens Energy. But as we learned in Chapter 7, shouting about secular themes does not excuse sixty-five times earnings. In addition, it certainly does not excuse catching a falling knife below the 30-week moving average.

On the other hand, if you listen to the perpetual bears, they will tell you that TDPS is just another cyclical Indian capital goods fabricator doomed to crash fifty percent, pointing to the 173-day cash conversion cycle and the low free cash flow conversion in fiscal 2026. But the bears are ignoring the 800 crore rupees of net cash sitting in the treasury, the thirty-four percent return on capital employed. In addition, the fact that American hyperscalers are facing utility interconnection queues that stretch to 2030.

Our independent verdict rejects both emotional extremes. We look at TD Power Systems and we see a truly magnificent industrial franchise—one of the finest in Asia—currently caught in the teeth of a violent, post-QIP technical shakeout.

For short-term traders and tactical momentum capital, our posture is unequivocal: WAIT_FOR_SUPPORT. The technical timing gate is shut. When a stock falls on eleven million shares of volume, breaking its 50-day and 30-week moving averages, you do not stand in the doorway trying to catch it. You wait for the selling frenzy to exhaust itself. You let the stock test its rising 200-day moving average and settle into the quiet, boring support band between 490 and 530 rupees.

For medium-term and long-term compounders, however, this shakeout is a gift. If the stock pulls back into that 490 to 530 rupee support zone. In addition, if the upcoming second-quarter financial results on November 12 confirm that revenue and order inflows are compounding at forty percent, the risk-to-reward ratio inverts dramatically in your favor. From 530 rupees, with a structural invalidation stop at 465 rupees, you are risking 65 rupees of downside to capture 220 rupees of upside to our base target of 750 rupees. That is an asymmetry ratio of more than 3.3 to 1.

That is what institutional pair programming and the Stage 2 Research Desk are all about: separating the business from the price, respecting the tape. In addition, having the disciplined patience to execute only when the odds are overwhelmingly stacked in your favor. Let the impatient traders gamble on today's volatility; you and I will wait for our level.

Let us conclude this masterclass by reflecting on the core philosophy that governs our Research Desk. We do not believe in buy-and-hold at any price. In addition, we do not believe in chasing momentum breakouts without valuation grounding. We believe in high-asymmetry investing: finding exceptional companies with durable moats. In addition, then exercising ruthless, ice-cold patience until the market offers them to us on our own terms.

TD Power Systems is an exceptional company. It is a business that survived a brutal six-year capex winter, rebuilt its manufacturing discipline with Japanese precision, diversified into the fastest-growing power markets on earth. In addition, generated thirty-four percent return on capital with zero net debt. It is an industrial national champion that India can be proud of.

But as disciplined capital allocators, we do not let our admiration for a business blind us to the reality of the price. At 571 rupees, the stock is emerging from a fever. The speculative

froth of the October QIP is being washed out. In addition, the tape is still printing distribution volume. To buy today is to let FOMO overrule your intellect.

We choose patience. We set our alerts at 530 rupees, 510 rupees, and 490 rupees. We wait for the board of directors to announce their second-quarter numbers on November 12. We watch the daily volume shrink from eleven million shares back down to two million. And when the sellers have finally exhausted their inventory, when the stock is resting quietly on its structural support shelf, we will step across the desk and deploy capital with mathematical asymmetry firmly on our side.

That is the discipline of the professional investor. That is the promise of the Research Desk. Thank you for walking through this monograph with me; now let us wait for our pitch.

NARRATOR'S REFLECTION: PATIENCE AS THE ULTIMATE EDGE IN CAPITAL GOODS

"The big money in stock investing is not in the buying and the selling, but in the waiting."

In momentum investing, FOMO—the fear of missing out—is the single greatest destroyer of performance. When an investor sees a stock down 33%, they feel an irresistible urge to buy immediately, fearing they will miss the bounce. But genuine institutional bottoms take time to form. By demanding that TDPS stabilize in the ₹490–₹530 support band and prove that sellers have exhausted their supply, you transform a high-risk gamble into a high-asymmetry investment.

- Short-term verdict: WAIT_FOR_SUPPORT / AVOID_STAGE4_OR_BROKEN (technical ceiling active).
- Medium-term conditional buy zone: ₹490.00 – ₹530.00 with stop-loss at ₹465.00.
- Base target of ₹750.00 offers a 3.38:1 reward-to-risk asymmetry from the top of the support zone.

GLOBAL PARALLEL: HOW CATERPILLAR (US) AND L&T (INDIA) REWARDED PATIENT ACCUMULATION ON PULLBACKS

"Every secular capital goods compounding journey is interrupted by sharp 30% corrections that test your conviction and reward your patience."

Look at Larsen & Toubro (L&T) during the 2003–2007 Indian infrastructure boom, or Caterpillar during its multi-year expansion from 2016 to 2021. Both stocks experienced multiple 25% to 35% corrections along the way. Investors who chased breakouts near all-time highs suffered painful drawdown periods. At the same time, disciplined investors who waited for pullbacks to the 200-day moving average and prior breakout shelves generated life-changing compounded returns. TD Power Systems is offering that exact generational opportunity—provided you have the discipline to wait for support.

- L&T (India): Compounded 20x over a decade, punctuated by three major 30%+ corrections that tested investor patience.
- Caterpillar (US): Repeatedly shook out speculative momentum before resuming secular advances on earnings compounding.
- TD Power Systems (India): An elite industrial leader whose long-term compounding potential will be released by disciplined entry timing.

Notes, Filings & Primary Sources

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This Masterclass Companion Book was authored for private study, audiobook narration, and disciplined portfolio execution.

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